

Drake Thorne

Network Platform Engineer | DevOps | AWS & Kubernetes | Ansible & Python Automation

Haymarket, NSW | contact@drakethorne.com

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Bash, PowerShell

DevOps: Ansible, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Git

Cloud & Infra: AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, RDS, S3), Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS), Windows Server, VMware

Networking: NetBox, Cisco IOS/NX-OS, Juniper Mist, Brocade, FortiGate, Wireshark, Nginx, Apache

EXPERIENCE

NINE ENTERTAINMENT

North Sydney, NSW

Network Platform Engineer

Aug 2024 – Present

- Built and operationalized a full site **EVPN-VXLAN** spine-leaf fabric on Juniper Mist using **Terraform**, **Ansible**, and **Python**, automating host-var driven provisioning and multicast integration across 40 switches via **GitHub Actions** CI/CD.
- Architected and deployed **NetBox** on **AWS EKS** with **Helm**, RDS/Postgres, S3, ALB ingress, and Okta SAML/Django Auth, serving as the dynamic inventory for all Ansible automation jobs across 1500+ devices.
- Developed and maintained **Ansible** automation workflows for RESTful API webservices such as Cloudflare, NetBox, Infoblox, LogicMonitor, ServiceNow, FortiManager, Cisco ISE, Cisco Catalyst Center, and 1Password.
- Developed and managed the end-to-end **Ansible** integration of ERSPAN unicast monitoring across network switches and ExtraHop appliances, giving 80% network visibility of unicast RX traffic.
- Built production-grade, repeatable EKS microservice deployments for Netbox, Docker Registry (ECR pull-through cache), Oxidized, Wiz, Image Swapper, and ArgoCD, using layered abstractions with YAML manifests, Helm, and **Dockerfiles**.
- Monitored and remediated containerized workloads on **AWS EKS**, leveraging **Prometheus** and **Grafana** to analyze OpenTelemetry metrics and diagnose pod failures, performance bottlenecks, and cluster resource constraints.
- Optimized CI pipelines via **GitHub Actions** with Bash, Python, and YAML pre-commit hooks to enforce linting and syntax standards. Built CD pipelines to update container image tags in ECR and trigger Ansible jobs in AWX via webhooks.
- Automated **AWS RDS** lifecycle management with **Ansible**, pruning outdated dev instances and rebuilding from production snapshots. Reduced manual build times from 10 minutes to seconds (99%-time reduction).
- Developed custom **Python** lookup and filter plugins to perform dynamic data manipulation, variable transformation, and NetBox data normalization.

FIN DESIGN + EFFECTS

Surry Hills, NSW

Systems Administrator

Apr 2023 – Aug 2024

- Led the end-to-end implementation of a complete monitoring and telemetry stack, using **Zabbix**, **Grafana**, and **Graylog**. Developed log/metric collecting, dashboards, data pipelines, and alerting across 500+ nodes, improving system observability, and reducing incident response times.
- Developed automation for infrastructure using **Ansible** playbooks, managing Linux fleet configs, CRON jobs, and patching routines across 50+ nodes, significantly reducing manual overhead.
- Designed and implemented secure remote access systems via Duo Proxy MFA, L2TP VPNs, and hardened reverse proxy gateways using Apache and Nginx.
- Managed hybrid infrastructure spanning Windows Servers, VMware, TrueNAS, GCP, and Linux systems (Ubuntu, CentOS).
- Designed and managed Layer 2/3 Brocade and Cisco networks – VLANs, VRFs, LAGs/LACP, NAT, and static routing.
- Enforced security with ACL configurations, Barracuda firewall management, and encryption scripting with **PowerShell**.

EDUCATION

MACQUARIE UNIVERSITY

North Ryde, NSW

Diploma of Information Technology, Computer Science

Graduated 2022

WAM: 81.875

Awards/Societies: Macquarie Association of Computing Students (MACS), Academic Integrity Certification